

SambaNova Systems

AI Inference Infrastructure · Chips & Systems · Palo Alto, California (founded 2017) · Private (\$11B post-money; \$1B Series F first close, Jul 2026)

SambaNova, the Palo Alto AI-chip maker, completed the first close of a \$1B Series F at an \$11B post-money valuation on 8 July 2026, led by General Atlantic, five months after a \$350M Series E at a reported \$2.2B. JPMorganChase was named an on-premises inference customer the same day.

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OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

TGR Haas F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

General Atlantic led the \$1B first close, with Seligman Ventures, T. Rowe Price Associates and Capital Group, alongside BlackRock, Intel Capital, the Qatar Investment Authority, Battery Ventures and Vista Equity Partners; a second close was expected within weeks. Five months earlier SambaNova raised a \$350M Series E with Intel after Bloomberg-reported takeover talks near \$1.6B stalled, so the price has risen roughly fivefold since February. Proceeds expand production of the SN40L and the SN50, shipping in the second half of 2026 with SoftBank first. Liang says a 2027 IPO is under consideration (reported). The grid has a precedent: McLaren named Groq an Official Partner in September 2025, putting an inference chip on the car from the Singapore GP with a pitch of fast, cost-efficient intelligence for analysis and development. SambaNova is the other US inference-silicon company at scale, now with JPMorganChase running its systems on-premises. It has no seat, and it is the one with a public-market clock starting to run.

WHY NOW

The first close landed on 8 July with a second expected within weeks, and the SN50 ships in the second half of 2026. The United States GP in October and the Las Vegas GP in November fall inside the window, and a 2027 listing makes 2027 the brand-build year.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$1B

\$1B first close of a Series F at an \$11B post-money valuation, led by General Atlantic with Seligman Ventur...

\$350M

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GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

MoneyGram Haas F1 Team	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
McLaren F1 Team	TAKEN	Dell Technologies
Aston Martin Aramco F1 Team	TAKEN	NetApp
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A \$1B first close at \$11B, a fivefold re-rating in five months, JPMorganChase on-premises and an IPO under consideration put SambaNova at peak brand-investment authority. Haas has no compute or chip partner, Groq at McLaren proved the category, and two US races remain inside the window.

WHY TGR HAAS F1 TEAM

Haas is the American team with no compute, AI or chip partner: Toyota Gazoo Racing as title and technical partner, Mphasis for digital services, CommScope and Ruckus for connectivity, no silicon. It is the lean privateer, so a partner that installs capability the team could not buy is worth more here than anywhere. Kannapolis and Banbury give SambaNova a US and a UK site; three home races put the brand in front of its buyers.

VALUE TO TGR HAAS F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. An SN40L system at Banbury running open-weight models on the team's own data: strategy post-processing between sessions, telemetry anomaly detection, engineering-document and simulation copilots, none of it leaving the building. JPMorganChase chose SambaNova for that private, on-premises inference. The hardware can form part of the consideration for a cost-capped team; for SambaNova, a reference deployment to show every sovereign and enterprise buyer.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official AI Inference Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, spanning the SN50 ramp and a possible 2027 listing. Estimated \$4-7M a year, part-payable in systems and support. Scope: sidepod or rear-wing placement, naming of the team's inference environment, US-race hospitality, engineering content from Banbury.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Rodrigo Liang

CO-FOUNDER & CEO, SAMBANOVA SYSTEMS · VERIFIED

Liang co-founded SambaNova in 2017 with Stanford professors Kunle Olukotun and Christopher Ré after leading processor development at Sun Microsystems and Oracle. Path: Annie Shea Weckesser, Chief Marketing Officer; Harry Ault, Chief Revenue Officer; Matt Padfield, CFO since June 2026.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the Groq precedent.

“Rodrigo, Groq put its chip on a McLaren the season it needed the story. You have just raised \$1B at \$11B with a listing in view, and the American team has no silicon partner. JPMorgan runs you on-premises; a race team could. 25 minutes before Austin?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 17 / 20 First close 8 Jul, second pending; Austin and Las Vegas in window.	CAPACITY 18 / 20 \$1B first close at \$11B; ~\$2.5B raised in total (reported).	BRAND FIT 14 / 20 B2B silicon brand; a listing narrative needs a stage.	URGENCY 13 / 20 IPO under consideration for 2027 (reported); no filing.	OPS FIT 15 / 20 MODE A: on-premises inference; no AI or chip partner at Haas.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

SECOND CLOSE UNCONFIRMED The 8 July release called it a first close with more expected within weeks; no completion had been announced by early September. **Counter:** Anchor on the \$1B first close; ask for the final size and the IPO timetable on the call.

GROQ GOT THERE FIRST McLaren's Groq deal owns the inference-chip narrative on the grid; a second entrant risks reading as a copy. **Counter:** Sell the on-premises deployment and the JPMorgan private-inference story: a system in the factory, not a logo.

SOURCES — 17 OF 17 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260612257950/en/SambaNova-Names-Engineering-and-Finance-Leaders-to-Accelerate-Growth-as-Customer-Demand-Surges
- https://www.generalatlantic.com/media-article/sambanova-completes-first-close-of-1-billion-financing-at-11-billion-valuation/
- https://www.cnn.com/2026/02/24/intel-partners-with-sambanova-after-buyout-talks-reportedly-failed.html